MathsJam Shout

May 2026
Election Special

Inspired by the recent local elections in the UK, this month's Shout is themed around democracy and elections!

Play Gerrymander Logic Puzzle

Play this online game and draw the boundaries to skew the outcome of an election in favour of one party or the other! It's fun! Don't think about the implications!

Play online: busalonium.itch.io/gerrymander-dx

Draw Misleading Charts

Follow in the great tradition of UK local elections and make a graph of what's going on in your pub/at your MathsJam. Truncate the axes, make the bars pointy, and mislead us all. Bonus points if one of the bars is labelled 'Can't win here!'

More inspiration: electionleaflets.org

Design BBC Election Number Logo

We're enjoying this funky isometric design the BBC uses for their election coverage logos.

Can you design the equivalent shapes for all the digits 0-9, using isometric paper?

Isometric paper: incompetech.com/graphpaper





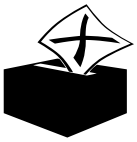
Puzzle Voting Systems

A group of 55 voters, choosing between five candidates A-E, have the following orders of preference for the candidates:

18 voters: A, D, E, C, B
12 voters: B, E, D, C, A
10 voters: C, B, E, D, A
9 voters: D, C, E, B, A
4 voters: E, B, D, C, A
2 voters: E, C, D, B, A

Under a plurality/first-past-the-post voting system, candidate A would win, as everyone would vote for their first choice, A would get 18 votes and nobody else would have more than that.

Can you find other established voting systems under which each of the four other candidates would win instead?



MathsJam Shout is a monthly sheet of ideas for activities to do at a MathsJam night. It's created using suggestions from a different MathsJam each month, and if you'd like to submit suggestions for a month in the future, email **katie@mathsjam.com**

Maths Jam is a monthly opportunity for like-minded self-confessed maths enthusiasts to get together in a pub and share stuff they like. Puzzles, games, problems, or just anything they think is cool or interesting. Monthly Maths Jam nights happen in over 70 locations around the world, on the second-to-last Tuesday of each month. To find your nearest Maths Jam, visit the website at **mathsjam.com.**